MORGAN SZIRAKI

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SUMMARY

Principal DevOps & Platform Engineer with 20+ years of experience standardising infrastructure across hybrid, bare-metal, virtualised, on-premise and cloud environments. Expert in GitHub Actions, Terraform, Ansible, and Packer — with a proven track record of building CI/CD frameworks from scratch, rationalising acquired and mixed estates, and delivering automation-first platforms that engineering teams can rely on. Advocates for pragmatic containerisation, composable tooling, and iterative delivery over monolithic solutions.

EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps Engineer

Scalpel Ltd **June 2025 - January 2026, London UK**

- Designed and maintained specialized ML training environments utilising Docker Compose, reducing developer onboarding time and simplifying local development workflows.
- Architected and automated AWS infrastructure provisioning for AI/ML development, testing, staging and production environments using Terraform, achieving full environment parity between staging and production.
- Developed a bespoke Linux distribution tailored to AI model training workloads, optimising system performance and reducing pipeline latency.
- Engineered a robust GitOps workflow for infrastructure management, using Terraform to ensure configuration idempotency and drift prevention.
- Provided cloud domain expertise to optimize ML model training pipelines, implementing cost-efficient compute strategies and reducing infrastructure overhead.
- Collaborated closely with ML engineers to identify and resolve complex platform and infrastructure blockers, serving as a technical mentor and SME for DevOps best practices.

Senior Platform Engineer

Zilch Technology **August 2024 - March 2025, London UK**

- Engineered and maintained hybrid infrastructure spanning AWS and on-premise environments using Terraform, achieving 100% configuration consistency and idempotency across the estate.
- Orchestrated a major migration from legacy CI/CD tools to GitHub Actions, standardising build processes for 20+ microservices and reducing deployment lead times.
- Optimized Docker image build strategies with multi-stage builds, reducing build times by 50%.
- Mentored and led a team of senior engineers, fostering a culture of automation-first problem solving and high-quality technical documentation.

DevOps, LiveOps

Supermassive Games **March 2023 - April 2024, Guildford, UK**

- Owned the end-to-end build and deployment infrastructure for multiple AAA game titles, focusing on high-performance on-premise build farms and hybrid cloud bursts.
- Streamlined and simplified complex build environments using Docker Compose, achieving development and production parity across diverse hardware configurations.
- Developed custom automation tools in Python and Bash to manage large-scale data synchronization and artifact distribution across global studios.
- Managed and automated on-premise infrastructure using Ansible, ensuring reliable and repeatable configurations for Windows and Linux-based build agents.
- Collaborated with game developers to identify and eliminate pipeline bottlenecks, significantly improving build turnaround times and developer productivity.
- Implemented robust monitoring and alerting for the build infrastructure using Splunk, enabling proactive identification and resolution of system incidents.
- Championed a "simplification-first" approach to automation, reducing technical debt and lowering the operational overhead of the build system.
- Instituted CI/CD pipelines leveraging Jenkins and GitHub Actions, seamlessly integrating automated testing, artifact tracking, and multi-environment deployments for AAA game releases.
- Engineered a scalable live deployment framework using Terraform and Kubernetes, supporting zero-downtime rollouts and enabling uninterrupted updates for over 3M daily active users across cloud-based multiplayer game servers.

SRE Technical Lead, DevOps

Centrica Hive **July 2015 - May 2022, London, UK**

- Developed Ruby-based provisioning, deployment and orchestration tooling for AWS.
- Implemented Kafka messaging architecture as a microservice.
- Developed cost and usage monitoring tools.
- Created self-service, federated user authentication accross AWS cloud estate.
- Created containerised development and testing environments using Docker, Vagrant, and VMWare to provide a functionally complete and portable ecosystem.

- Developed provisioning framework using Packer, Ansible and Puppet.
- Created build pipelines using GitHub Actions, Teamcity, AWS Services.
- Linux administration and kernel mods to support Java devs.
- Observability using Wavefront, Cloudwatch, Kibana with Elasitic Search (+ Lua development).
- Modernized continuous integration and delivery workflows for over 25 microservices by introducing automated canary deployments and blue-green strategies, achieving a 45% reduction in production incident rates and enhancing deployment frequency by 60% using Kubernetes, Helm, and AWS CodePipeline.

Senior Consultant

Cartesian **May 2000 - June 2015, London, UK**

- Delivered complex infrastructure and billing assurance migrations for global clients, including high-stakes merger scenarios between NTL and Telewest, to standardize systems and ensure operational consistency.
- Designed and maintained modular Object-Oriented Perl frameworks to automate mediation system processing, ensuring data integrity and high-performance throughput.
- Managed and optimized large-scale Linux server environments to support critical financial and telecommunication systems.
- Provided technical leadership and training to client engineering teams, successfully transitioning them to automated infrastructure management workflows.
- Spearheaded performance tuning initiatives for critical mediation systems, resulting in improved processing efficiency and reduced system downtime.
- Integrated cross-platform data feeds into legacy mediation platforms by developing robust data transformation pipelines, enabling unified analytics for telecommunications client environments.

EDUCATION

Degree: Microbiology & Biochemistry

Minor in Music • University of California San Diego • 1984-1990

SKILLS

CI/CD & DevOps: GitHub Actions (Expert), Jenkins, TeamCity, GitOps, Infrastructure Automation, Pipeline Frameworks

Skills 2: Kubernetes, GitOps, K3s, Docker, Docker-Compose, Docker-Swarm, Vagrant, Portainer, K9s

OS & Networking: Linux (Primary) & Windows Administration, Networking, Security Tooling (Kali), Bash/Shell since 1996

Skills 4: Ruby, Rails, Sinatra, Kotlin, Java, Python, Perl, C, Shell, Expect

Collaboration: Jira, PagerDuty, Mentorship, Technical Leadership, Documentation, Agile Delivery

AWS: Cloudformation, VPC, EC2, Autoscaling Groups, Subnets, API Gateway, CloudWatch, Event Bridge

Skills 8: Agile, Scrum, Kanban

Messaging & Data: Kafka, RabbitMQ, MQTT, Mosquitto, SQL, NoSQL (Postgres, DynamoDB, Redis, ElasticSearch)

IaC & Config Management: Terraform (Expert), Ansible (Expert), Puppet, Chef, CloudFormation, Open Policy Agent (OPA)

Monitoring: Wavefront, CloudWatch, Grafana, Kibana, DataDog